

CBS1A01P Fun with Language
Term 3, 2025-2026

Lectures: Mon & Tue at 16:30-18:20 in Y305: **please refer to the schedule below** for dates where no face-to-face (f2f) lectures take place and the “flipped classroom” mode is used

- Lecturer: Dr. Wing-Li WU 胡永利 (wing-li.wu@polyu.edu.hk)

Seminars: all are face-to-face classes; please refer to your class timetable for the specific dates

- SEM001: Mon 10:30-11:20 & Tue 09:30-10:20 in R507 (Tutor: WU Ruofan)
- SEM002: Mon 10:30-11:20 & Tue 09:30-10:20 in R508 (Tutor: ZHU Yuhong)
- SEM003: Mon 10:30-11:20 & Tue 09:30-10:20 in R502 (Tutor: ZHOU Jingjing)

Assessments

Seminar participation (5%)	▪ participation in seminars to be graded from the teaching week after the Add/Drop period onwards
In-class exercises (15%)	▪ two online (Blackboard) quizzes (open book; 7% + 8%): dates indicated on page 2
Homework (HW) (40%)	▪ HW1 (15%) + HW2 (25%): both to be submitted via the CBS1A01P Blackboard
Essay (40%)	▪ the <u>second draft</u> is assessed in terms of the CW requirements (10%) ▪ full essay (30%) ▪ please check CW-related information on the Blackboard: 通識課程中文寫作工作表(一) & 重要通告

Main Readings:

- Fromkin, V., Rodman, R. and Hyams N. (2014). *An Introduction to Language* (10th ed.). Cengage Learning. [Reserve Coll: P106 .F75 2014]
- 叶蜚声、徐通锵。1981 《语言学纲要》。北京：北京大学出版社。(Chinese Reading requirement: pp. 1-197) [Circulation Coll: P121.Y44] [electronic resource:
<http://ezproxy.lib.polyu.edu.hk/login?auth=alogin&url=http://jullaccdc.lib.apabi.com/product.asp?DocID=35967>]

Recommended readings:

- Crystal, D. (2010). *The Cambridge Encyclopedia of Language* (3rd ed.). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. [Reference Coll: P29 .C64 2010]
- Trask, R.L. (1997). *A Student's Dictionary of Language and Linguistics*. London: Arnold. [Reference Coll: P29 .T69 1997]
- Yule, G. (2010). *The Study of Language* (4th ed.). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. [Circulation Coll: P106 .Y85 2010]
- 熊学亮 (2010)。《语言学导论》。上海：复旦大学出版社。[electronic resource:
<http://ezproxy.lib.polyu.edu.hk/login?auth=alogin&url=http://jullaccdc.lib.apabi.com/product.asp?DocID=104061>]
- 王士元 (2011)。《语言、演化与大脑》。北京：商务印书馆。
- 纪秀生、王建设 (2010)。《现代语言学通论》。昆明：云南大学出版社。[electronic resource:
<http://ezproxy.lib.polyu.edu.hk/login?auth=alogin&url=http://jullaccdc.lib.apabi.com/product.asp?DocID=103950>]

Schedule: Lectures, Seminars, Homework, Essay, Worksheets

- L1, L2, etc. refer to the Lectures; SEM001-L1 means “seminar group 1 reviewing L1 contents”

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1		<u>May-26</u> L1	<u>27</u>	<u>28</u>	<u>29</u>	<u>30</u>	<u>31</u>
2	<u>Jun-1</u> SEM001/002/003-L1 L2	<u>2</u> SEM001/002/003-L2 L3	<u>3</u>	<u>4</u>	<u>5</u>	<u>6</u>	<u>7</u> essay first draft
3	<u>8</u> SEM001/002/003-L3 L4	<u>9</u> SEM001/002/003-L4 L5 – no f2f lecture: “flipped classroom”	<u>10</u>	<u>11</u>	<u>12</u>	<u>13</u>	<u>14</u>
4	<u>15</u> SEM001/002/003-L5 L6	<u>16</u> SEM001/002/003-L6 Quiz 1 L7 – no f2f lecture: “flipped classroom”	<u>17</u> HW1	<u>18</u>	<u>19</u>	<u>20</u>	<u>21</u> essay 2nd draft
5	<u>22</u> SEM001/002/003-L7 L8	<u>23</u> SEM001/002/003-L8 L9 – no f2f lecture: “flipped classroom”	<u>24</u>	<u>25</u>	<u>26</u>	<u>27</u>	<u>28</u>
6	<u>29</u> SEM001/002/003-L9 L10	<u>30</u> SEM001/002/003-L10 L11 – no f2f lecture: “flipped classroom”	<u>Jul-1</u>	<u>2</u>	<u>3</u>	<u>4</u>	<u>5</u> HW2
7	<u>6</u> SEM001/002/003-L11 L12	<u>7</u> SEM001/002/003-L12 L13 Quiz 2	<u>8</u>	<u>9</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>11</u>	<u>12</u>
	<u>13</u>	<u>14</u> Final essay					

NOTE: for lectures marked as “flipped classroom”, students watch pre-recorded lectures and complete activities (e.g., reading assigned reference materials, collecting language examples) to be discussed in the seminars which review those lectures

Lecture schedule and important dates

(the lecture topics listed below are subject to change as the term progresses)

Week	Lecture No.	Date	Topic	Note	Assessment weighting
1	L1	26-May	What is language? Animal Communication vs. Human Language		
2	L2	1-Jun	Children's acquisition of language		
2	L3	2-Jun	Sounds of language (1)		
3	L4	8-Jun	Sounds of language (2)	essay 1st draft by 7-Jun (Sun)	not graded
3	L5	9-Jun	Sounds of language (3)		
4	L6	15-Jun	Structure of words		
4	L7	16-Jun	Meaning of words	Quiz 1: 16-Jun (Tue) HW1 by 17-Jun (Wed)	7% 15%
5	L8	22-Jun	Structure and meaning of sentences	essay 2nd draft by 21-Jun (Sun)	10%
5	L9	23-Jun	Interpretation and understanding of utterances		
6	L10	29-Jun	Languages and dialects		
6	L11	30-Jul	Language contact		
7	L12	6-Jul	Writing systems	HW2 by 7-Jul (Sun)	25%
7	L13	7-Jul	Language and the brain	Quiz 2: 9-Jul (Tue)	8%
		14-Jul		full essay by 14-Jul (Tue)	30%
				seminar participation	5%
					100%

➤ Chinese Writing (CW)

第一稿 (700 字, 不計分)	7-Jun-2026 (Sun) (經 CR/CW 的 Blackboard /名字含 CWT/ 提交)
第二稿 (2000 字)	21-Jun-2026 (Sun) (經 CR/CW 的 Blackboard /名字含 CWT/ 提交)
最終稿 (2000-3000 字, 上限 3300 字)	14-Jul-2026 (Tue) (經 CBS1A01P 的 Blackboard 提交)

字數計算：包括正文的標點符號、段落標題，但不包括論文的標題、摘要 (abstract)、關鍵詞和參考文獻 (reference list) 的字數。

注意：請到 Blackboard 查閱 CW 相關資訊。